

LEPTOSPERMUM

planted against a south- or west-facing wall. Requires a position in full sun and fertile, well-drained soil. Propagate by semiripe cuttings in summer.

L. humifusum. See *L. rupestre*.

L. rupestre, syn. *L. humifusum*, illus. p.151.

L. scoparium (Manuka, New Zealand tea-tree) illus. p.130. ‘**Appleblossom**’ is an evergreen, rounded shrub. H and S 10ft (3m). Narrowly lance-shaped, aromatic, gray-green leaves set off a profusion of large, star-shaped, white flowers overlaid with pink, in late spring and summer. ‘**Kiwi**’, H 3ft (1m), is a dwarf form with purple-tinged young foliage and dark crimson flowers. Good for a rock garden or alpine house.

‘**Nicholsii**’ has bronze-purple leaves and smaller, crimson flowers. ‘**Red Damask**’ illus. p.123. ‘**Silver Sheen**’ has softly hairy silvery leaves on reddish shoots and white flowers. ‘**Snow Flurry**’ has double white flowers. Z8–11

LESCHENAULTIA

SYN. LECHENAULTIA

GOODENIACEAE

Genus of evergreen shrubs, subshrubs, and perennials, grown for their showy flowers. Frost tender. Needs full light and peaty, well-drained soil with few phosphates and nitrates. Water pot plants moderately during growing season, sparingly at other times. Shorten overlong stems after flowering. Propagate by seed in spring or by semiripe cuttings in summer. Most species are not easy to grow under glass; good ventilation is essential.

L. floribunda. Evergreen, shrubby, woody-based perennial or short-lived shrub. H 18in (45cm), S 14in (35cm). Has narrowly oblong to linear, pointed, mid-green leaves, and in spring-summer, short, tubular, pale blue flowers, with 5 angular petals, in terminal clusters. Z10–11 (min. 41–45°F/5–7°C)

LEUCADENDRON

PROTEACEAE

Genus of evergreen shrubs and trees, grown for their flower heads from fall to spring and for their foliage. Frost hardy to frost tender. Needs full light and sharply drained soil, mainly of sand and peat, ideally with very little nitrogen and phosphates. Water potted specimens moderately while in growth, sparingly at other times. Propagate by seed in spring.

L. argenteum (Silver tree) illus. p.451.

L. ‘Safari Sunset’. Evergreen, erect, freely branching, vigorous shrub. H to 8ft (2.5m), S to 6ft (1.8m) or more. Has narrowly oblong leaves, deep green flushed purple-red, more colorful when young. From fall to spring, bears yellowish-green flower heads surrounded by light red bracts, maturing purple red, fading to yellow. Z9–11

LEUCANTHEMELLA

ASTERACEAE/COMPOSITAE

Genus of hairy perennials, grown for their daisylike flower heads in fall. Fully hardy. Grow in full sun or partial shade and

reliably moist soil. Propagate by division or basal cuttings in spring.

L. serotina, syn. *Chrysanthemum serotinum*, *C. uliginosum*, illus. p.220.

LEUCANTHEMOPSIS

ASTERACEAE/COMPOSITAE

Genus of dwarf, tufted, clump- or mat-forming perennials, grown for their solitary, daisylike flower heads in summer. Fully hardy. Grow in full sun and sharply drained soil. Propagate by seed as soon as they are ripe, or by division or basal cuttings taken in spring.

L. alpina, syn. *Chrysanthemum alpinum* (Alpine chrysanthemum). Tuft-forming, short-lived perennial. H 4in (10cm), S 8in (20cm). Small tufts of deeply cut leaves are produced from short, rhizomatous stems. In summer, bears large, white flower heads with yellow centers. Good for rock or scree gardens, or alpine planters. Z5–9

LEUCANTHEMUM

ASTERACEAE/COMPOSITAE

Genus of annuals and perennials, grown for their attractive flowers. Fully to frost hardy. Cultivars of *L. × superbum* are valued for their profusion of large daisylike summer flowers. Some species are suitable for rock gardens. Needs full sun and well-drained soil. Taller cultivars require staking. Propagate species by seed or division, cultivars by division only.

L. × superbum, syn. *Chrysanthemum maximum* of gardens, *C. × superbum* (Shasta daisy). Robust perennial. H 3ft (90cm), S 2ft (60cm). Has inversely lance-shaped, toothed, glossy, almost fleshy, dark green basal leaves and shorter, stalkless, stem leaves. From early summer to early fall, bears solitary, single or double, white flower heads, 4–5in (10–12cm) across, with yellow disk florets, paler in the double-flowered forms. Z5–9.

‘**Aglaia**’ illus. p.230. ‘**Elizabeth**’ has large, single, pure white flower heads.

‘**Esther Read**’ illus. p.263.

‘**Sonnenschein**’ illus. p.231. ‘**Wirral Pride**’ illus. p.246. ‘**Wirral Supreme**’ is double with short, central florets.

LEUCHTENBERGIA

CACTACEAE

Genus of one species of perennial cactus. Looks like *Agave* in foliage, but its flowers, seed pods, and seeds are similar to *Ferocactus*. Tubercles eventually form on short, rough, woody stems. Frost tender. Needs full sun and very well-drained soil. Keep completely dry in winter; water sparingly from spring to fall. Propagate by seed in spring or summer.

L. principis illus. p.490.

LEUCOCORYNE

ALLIACEAE/LILIACEAE

Genus of spring-flowering bulbs with loose heads of flattish flowers. Frost tender. Needs sun and well-drained soil. Plant in fall, water well during their growing season, and keep almost dry when dormant in summer. Propagate by seed, or offsets in fall.

L. ixioides (Glory-of-the-sun). Spring-flowering bulb. H 18in (45cm), S 3in (8cm). Has long, narrow, semierect, basal leaves that wither by flowering time. Wiry, slender flower stem has a loose head of up to 10 lilac-blue flowers. Z10–11 (min. 41°F/5°C)

LEUCOGENES

New Zealand edelweiss

ASTERACEAE/COMPOSITAE

Genus of evergreen, woody-based perennials, grown for their foliage. Good for alpine houses in areas where summers are cool. Borderline fully hardy. Needs sun and gritty, well-drained, peaty soil. Resents winter wet. Propagate by seed when fresh or by softwood cuttings in late spring.

L. grandiceps illus. p.356.

L. leontopodium, syn. *Raoulia leontopodium* (North Island edelweiss). Evergreen, rosetted perennial. H and S 5in (12cm). Overlapping, oblong to ovate leaves are silvery-white to yellowish. Bears up to 15 small, star-shaped, woolly, silvery-white flower heads, surrounded by thick, felted, white bracts, in early summer. Z7–10

LEUCOJUM

Snowflake

AMARYLLIDACEAE

Genus of spring-flowering bulbs, grown for their pendent, bell-shaped, white or pink flowers. Fully hardy. Some species prefer a moist, partially shaded site, others do best in sun and well-drained soil. Propagate by division in spring or early fall or by seed in fall.

L. aestivum (Summer snowflake) illus. p.436. ‘**Gravetye Giant**’ illus. p.434.

L. fallale. See *Acis fallalis*.

L. hiemale. See *Acis hiemalis*.

L. nicaeense. See *Acis hiemalis*.

L. roseum. See *Acis rosea*.

L. vernum (Spring snowflake) illus. p.414.

LEUCOPHYTA

Cushion bush

ASTERACEAE/COMPOSITAE

Genus of annuals, evergreen perennials, and small shrubs, often used as summer bedding. Frost tender. Needs well-drained soil and full light. Water container plants moderately when in full growth, sparingly at other times. Remove tips to promote a bushy habit. Propagate by semiripe cuttings in late summer. Botrytis may be troublesome if plants are kept too cool and damp during winter.

L. brownii, syn. *Calocephalus brownii*, illus. p.315.

LEUCOSPERMUM

PROTEACEAE

Genus of evergreen shrubs and small trees grown for their flower heads. Frost hardy to frost tender. Needs full light and sandy, well-drained soil with few nitrates and phosphates. Water container plants moderately when in growth, sparingly at other times. Propagate by seed in spring. Not easy to cultivate long term under glass; good ventilation is essential.

L. cordifolium, syn. *L. nutans*. Evergreen, rounded to spreading, well-branched

shrub. H to 6ft (2m), S 5–10ft (1.5–3m). Elongated, heart-shaped, blue-gray leaves each have a 3-toothed tip. In summer, very slender, tubular, brick-red to orange flowers, each with a long style, are borne in tight heads that resemble single blooms. Z10–11 (min. 41°F/5°C)

L. nutans. See *L. cordifolium*.

L. reflexum illus. p.456.

LEUCOTHÖE

ERICACEAE

Genus of evergreen, semievergreen, or deciduous shrubs, grown for their white flowers and their foliage. Fully hardy. Needs shade or partial shade and moist, peaty, acid soil. Propagate by semiripe cuttings in summer.

L. catesbaei of gardens. See *L. fontanesiana*.

L. fontanesiana, syn. *L. catesbaei* of gardens, *L. walteri* (Switch Ivy). Evergreen, arching shrub. H 5ft (1.5m), S 10ft (3m). Lance-shaped, leathery, glossy, dark green leaves have long points and sharp teeth. Short racemes of small, urn-shaped, white flowers are borne beneath shoots from mid- to late spring. Z6–9. ‘**Rainbow**’ illus. p.167. ‘**Scarletta (‘Zeblid’)**’ see *L. SCARLETTA* (‘Zeblid’). Z6–9

L. keiskei. Evergreen shrub with erect or semiproculumbent stems. H and S 2ft (60cm). Ovate, thin-textured, glossy, dark green leaves have a red flush when young and a leathery appearance. Bears pendent, urn-shaped, white flowers from leaf axils in summer. Good for a rock garden or alpine house. Prefers mild, damp climates. Z5–9

L. SCARLETTA (‘Zeblid’). Upright, evergreen shrub with arching branches. H and S 3–5ft (1–1.5m). Has dark red-purple young foliage, which turns dark green, then bronze to burgundy-red in winter. Plant in good light for best color. Z5–8

L. walteri. See *L. fontanesiana*.

LEWISIA

PORTULACACEAE

Genus of perennials, some of which are evergreen, with rosettes of succulent leaves and deep tap roots. Most species are good in alpine houses, troughs, and rock gardens. Fully to frost hardy. Evergreen species need partially shaded, humus-rich, moist or well-drained, neutral to acid soil and resent water in their rosettes at all times. Herbaceous species shed their leaves in summer and require sun and well-drained, neutral to acid soil; dry off after flowering. Propagate herbaceous species by seed in spring or fall, evergreen species by seed in spring or by offsets in summer. Seed of *L. Cotyledon* Hybrids may not come true.

L. columbiana. Evergreen, basal-rosetted perennial. H and S to 6in (15cm). Has thick, narrowly oblong, flat, glossy, green leaves. In early summer, bears terminal sprays of small, cup-shaped, deeply veined, white to deep pink flowers. Prefers moist soil. Z5–9

L. Cotyledon Hybrids illus. p.340.

L. ‘George Henley’ illus. p.338.

L. nevadensis. Loose, basal-rosetted perennial. H and S to 4in (10cm). In summer, large, almost stemless, cup-shaped, white